

Final Understanding of the Project

This project is about developing a **centralized research project management system** for sponsored academic/research projects.

The system is mainly designed for **Principal Investigators (PIs)**, while **Co-PIs, JRFs/SRFs, and other authorized members under the same project** can also access and track project-related information through controlled access.

Main Problem

Currently, research projects are managed using manual methods such as emails, spreadsheets, physical documents, and disconnected systems. Because of this:

- deadlines and milestones may be missed,
- documentation becomes repetitive and complex,
- budget and fund utilization tracking becomes difficult,
- procurement and purchasing processes are hard to monitor,
- communication between departments is inefficient,
- and funds may lapse due to delays in approvals or purchases.

Managing large sponsored projects therefore creates a heavy administrative burden on PIs and research teams.

Proposed Solution

The project proposes a **digital platform** that manages the complete workflow of sponsored research projects in one place.

The system will provide:

1. Project & Deadline Tracking

- Monitor milestones, reports, and submission dates.
- Send automated reminders and alerts.

2. Team Collaboration

- Allow PIs, Co-PIs, JRFs/SRFs, and other project members to track project activities and updates together.

3. Budget & Fund Monitoring

- Track allocated funds, expenditures, and remaining balance.
- Generate utilization and financial reports.

4. Procurement & Purchasing Management

- Track product orders, shipping, invoices, approvals, and delivery status.
- Store bills and procurement records digitally.
- Send reminders to avoid fund lapse/elapse.

5. Form & Report Automation

- Provide agency-specific templates and automatically generate required reports and documents.

6. Centralized Document Repository

- Maintain all project-related documents in a single secure location.

7. Communication & Transparency

- Improve coordination between researchers, administrators, and purchasing/finance divisions.

Overall Goal

The overall aim is to create a **transparent, collaborative, and efficient research project management system** that reduces manual administrative work, prevents delays and fund lapse, improves coordination, and helps researchers focus more on research activities rather than paperwork and tracking tasks.